



Going over your due date can be stressful, but it may help to remind yourself that it's also extremely common and quite normal.

BRINGING ON LABOR

Although no “home” or alternative remedy has been proven to bring on labor, there are several harmless techniques that are thought to assist the body’s natural processes in the countdown to labor.

- **Probably the most enjoyable way to try to bring on labor is to make love** with your partner. Sperm contains prostaglandins that may act as a natural uterine stimulant, although the evidence that this works is inconclusive. Making love is not dangerous to your baby, unless your doctor has specifically told you to refrain from intercourse for a medical reason, such as fetal growth restriction or placental bleeding.
- **Nipple stimulation during sex** or by itself can cause the release of oxytocin from your pituitary gland, which is linked to contractions and cervical ripening.